Neurodiversity & Inclusive Design

Abi Harrison-Nye

What is it for?

Neurodiversity describes the natural variations in how human brains function, process information, learn, and interact. Bad design can create problems for thinking and processing, such as:

- Cognitive overload caused by busy layouts, auto-playing videos, and flashing animations
- Using jargon, complex words, or vague phrases
- Menus, buttons, or layouts that change from page to page
- Long blocks of text, and unnecessary urgency

How to support it

- Keep it simple and clear, use plain English and short sentences
- Make it predictable, use headings and lists to organise content
- Reduce distractions, letting the user be in control. Avoid auto-playing videos or flashing animations
- Be forgiving. Write error messages that clearly explain what is wrong and how to fix it
- Make content easy to read by breaking up long text with headings, lists, and empty space

Useful Links

Neurodiversity and designing for difference

Scott Logic: Designing for Neurodiversity